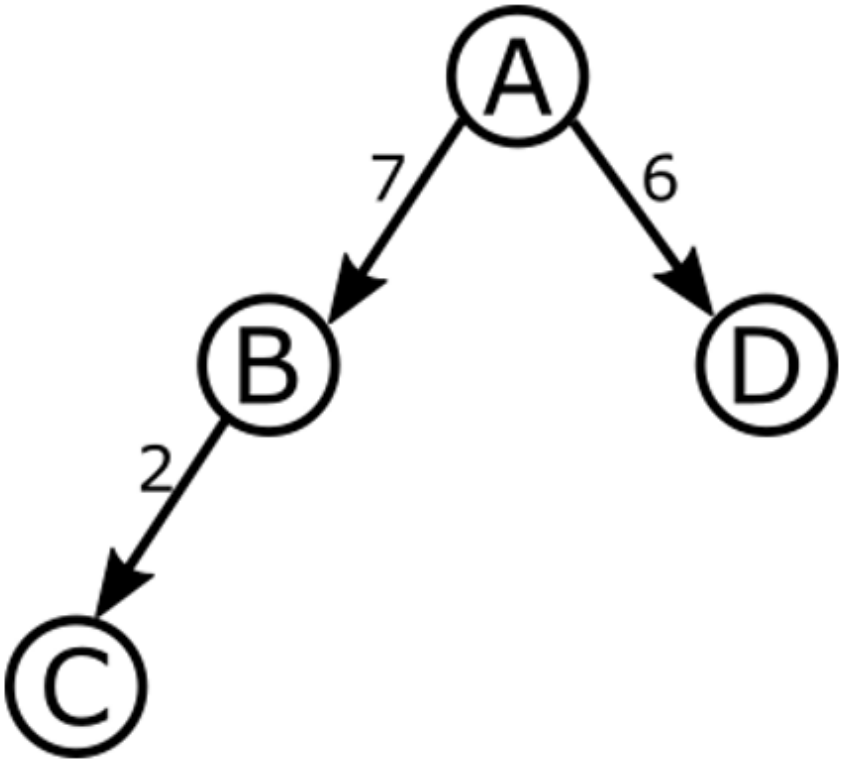


Figure 2.14 A spanning tree for the graph in the figure 2.13.

2.8.3 Data Compression: Huffman Codes

Huffman's algorithm is probably the most famous data compression algorithm, and you have likely already heard of it if you took an “introduction to CS” course. It is a simple, brilliant greedy algorithm that, despite not being the state of the art for compression anymore, was a major breakthrough in the '50s.

A Huffman code is a tree, built bottom up, starting with the list of different characters appearing in a text and their frequency. The algorithm iteratively